

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3290

Name

Ruthvik Bommena

Email

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Gender

Male

City, state, and country of residence

Champaign, Illinois, USA

Nationality

India

When did or will you finish your PhD?

May 2026

University Education

Doctor of Philosophy | Aerospace Engineering | University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign | May 2026

Master of Science | Aerospace Engineering | University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign | May 2023

Bachelor of Science | Mechanical Engineering | University of Illinois Chicago | May 2021

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

The significance of my PhD research, in the field of space sustainability, reflects not just my academic rigor but also my dedication to contributing to a field that thrives on international cooperation. The Science Corps fellowship, with its inherent cross-cultural aspect, presents a unique opportunity for me to share and extend my research with a global audience. Space endeavors, by their nature, transcend national boundaries and require a unified approach; this fellowship will enable me to contribute to and benefit from this global exchange of ideas and technologies. If selected for the Science

Corps fellowship, I bring a wealth of experience in collaborating with international peers. My past engagements with students and researchers from various nationalities have equipped me with a collaborative mindset and an appreciation for diverse cultural insights. I eagerly anticipate connecting with other Science Corps fellows, envisioning future collaborations that could potentially transform the landscape of science and technology. The fellowship would provide me with unparalleled resources, networks, and platforms to further my work, opening doors to new collaborations and innovations. I am eager to bring my experience to this fellowship, embodying the values of integrity, curiosity, and compassion towards creating a more equitable and sustainable world.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

Leadership in social change often begins with a single initiative, evolving into a lifelong commitment to making a difference. My journey towards creating positive societal impact began with a rewarding project at the Shalivahana Foundation. The initiative I led aimed to positively impact migrant child laborers in construction sites, driven by a belief in every child's right to a better future. Identifying over 100 children in hazardous conditions, I facilitated their transition to safer environments. Despite navigating complex environments and persuading skeptical stakeholders, the unwavering support of my team fueled our success. This experience deepened my grasp of compassion and the profound impact of focused efforts on improving the lives of the underprivileged.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, I transitioned to SHIELD Illinois, providing critical customer and technical support. Using data analytics, I led creative efforts to streamline patient feedback mechanisms and managed urgent issues which significantly improved the overall patient experience. This role reinforced my belief in the importance of teamwork and creativity in tackling societal challenges during a crisis of unprecedented scale.

As I embark on further endeavors, I carry with me lessons learned - the importance of resilience, empathy, and teamwork in transforming lives and communities for the better.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

As an aspiring PhD student in aerospace engineering, my research concentrates on developing technologies for In-space Servicing and Assembly (ISA). This area is crucial not only for its scientific allure but also for its significant societal impact, as it fosters space sustainability. ISA promises to conserve resources and make space exploration more accessible and feasible to rapidly developing nations like India.

My ultimate aspiration is to return to India as a professor, post-PhD, to impart the knowledge and expertise I have garnered. Education is a powerful catalyst for social change, and by teaching the next generation of scientists and engineers, I intend to ignite a passion for a sustainable aerospace industry. My academic and professional journey, enriched by collaborations with diverse organizations, from giants like NASA to dynamic startups, has instilled in me a profound understanding of the varied facets of the aerospace sector. My engagement with multicultural teams has honed my technical skills and also prepared me to effectively communicate and mentor future generations. This effort will create a knowledgeable workforce and also inspire a societal shift towards valuing sustainable practices in science and technology and ensure that these advancements are leveraged for the greater good of society.

CV/Resume [RuthvikBommena CV.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

Empty

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